

RONNIE ALFARO

Engineering Manager | AI & Infrastructure | 20+ Years in Technology

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PROFILE

Engineering Manager with 20+ years of experience spanning infrastructure, operations, and software engineering, now focused on AI systems and intelligent automation. Proven track record of building and scaling high-performing engineering teams. Deep technical fluency across the full stack—from Linux systems and cloud infrastructure to semantic search pipelines, vector databases, and multi-model AI orchestration. Adept at translating complex AI capabilities into measurable operational impact through process design, tooling innovation, and cross-functional leadership.

CORE COMPETENCIES

AI & LLM Engineering: LLM Integration (Claude API, Prompt Engineering) · AI Agent Architecture & Orchestration · Semantic Search (ChromaDB, Sentence-Transformers) · RAG Pipelines · Vector Databases · Multi-Model Workflows · NLP/Embeddings

Engineering & Infrastructure: Rust · Python · FastAPI · Docker · Kubernetes · Ansible · AWS · Linux/Unix (20+ yrs) · DNS · Databases (MySQL, PostgreSQL, Oracle, MS SQL) · Network Security · Cloud Architecture

Leadership & Process: Engineering Team Leadership (14+ reports) · Agile/Scrum · Lean Six Sigma Green Belt · Incident Management · Process Design & Automation · DevOps · JIRA · Confluence · ServiceNow

AI & TECHNICAL PROJECTS

https://gitlab.com/users/ronnie_alfaro/projects

RagIT | Personal Project (Python)2026

- An AI-driven literary analysis platform that converts books into interactive knowledge graphs. Leveraging vector search, semantic embeddings, Retrieval-Augmented Generation (RAG), and LLMs, the system generates chapter-level summaries, character networks, timeline reconstruction, and contextual insights across entire novels. Designed to solve long-context comprehension challenges in literature, enabling users to navigate and interrogate complex narratives with unprecedented depth and accuracy.

Arxiv Sanity Lite Modern | Personal Project (Python)2026

- Revived and modernized the original Arxiv Sanity project, reimagining its architecture and user experience for contemporary research workflows. Leveraging Python, semantic search, recommendation systems, metadata analysis, and modern web technologies, the platform helps researchers discover relevant papers, identify emerging trends, and efficiently navigate large volumes of scientific literature. Designed to preserve the strengths of the original concept while introducing a streamlined interface, improved performance, and enhanced research exploration capabilities.

Rustdrel | Personal Project (Python)2026

- Terminal roguelike card game in Rust, transforming the classic Scoundrel card game into an atmospheric dungeon crawler with ASCII visuals, animated TUI screens, sound effects, difficulty modes, combat mechanics, weapon durability, potions, event logs, and room-based progression. Built with a modular architecture using Ratatui, Crossterm, Rodio, and Rust game-state patterns, showcasing systems design, terminal UX, and cross-platform release packaging.

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Support Engineering Manager | GitLab *Feb 2020 – Present*

- Lead a high-performing team of 14 engineers consistently exceeding quarterly targets, with multiple direct reports promoted to management and Staff-level positions.
- Created automation tooling (Mechanizer) adopted company-wide and used for 5+ years, significantly reducing manual toil across support workflows.
- Designed and implemented core support processes including the STAR framework, Mechanizer workflow, and cross-team escalation protocols—several still in active use across the organization.
- Integrated AI-powered tooling and agent workflows into team operations, driving efficiency gains in ticket triage, knowledge retrieval, and resolution automation.
- Champion of process improvement through Lean Six Sigma methodology, continuously optimizing team throughput and quality metrics.

Senior Manager, Global Operations | TradeStation Technologies *Apr 2018 – Feb 2020*

- Scaled the team in size and scope, absorbing server patching, infrastructure support, ServiceNow development, JIRA/Confluence administration, and PowerBI dashboard creation.
- Defined enterprise-wide Incident Management guidelines and implemented ServiceNow solutions for corporate operational needs.
- Drove process improvement initiatives that expanded team responsibilities while reducing associated costs.
- Operated under DevOps methodology, bridging development and operations for faster delivery cycles.

IT & Systems Team Leader | Experian *Mar 2013 – Jan 2017*

- Led a cross-functional technology team, defining individual responsibilities and driving performance through coaching and structured training workshops.
- Managed release approval processes for multiple product lines, ensuring quality gates and compliance.
- Identified performance gaps and implemented targeted coaching programs, elevating underperforming team members.

Application Operations Engineer Senior | Experian (Cheetahmail) *Nov 2011 – Mar 2013*

- Supported a business-critical email platform across database, Linux, scripting, network, and incident management domains.
- Developed automation scripts to streamline operational procedures and reduce manual intervention.
- Created Performance Improvement Plans and led remediation for underperforming team members.

Senior Solution Architect / Senior Sysadmin | Arcus (Comcast Partner) *Sep 2010 – Nov 2011*

- Resolved BSS tickets for Solaris and RedHat Linux environments as a Comcast business partner, operating with high autonomy.
- Architected Linux infrastructure on AWS for WodaBiz Inc., configuring high-availability setups with load balancers and Amazon RDS.
- Maintained Comodo Hacker Proof certification through daily security audits and compliance verification.

IT Manager | Event by Wire *Sep 2008 – Sep 2010*

- Led the technology department for a video streaming company, managing a team of 10 across development, design, and SEO.
- Acted as software architect for new products, selecting technologies and directing product development strategy.
- Gained deep experience with streaming technologies including Windows Media Server and Flash Video.